

Shabbat Table Reading

Friday, October 2, 2026 • 21 Tishrei 5787
Shabbat • Hoshana Rabbah • Approaching Simchat Torah

Welcoming Shabbat

Reader: Tonight we enter Shabbat at the close of Sukkot and on the threshold of Simchat Torah. We stand between ending and beginning. Soon Torah reaches its final words—and immediately begins again.

Together: Shabbat Shalom. May this be a Shabbat of peace, gratitude, learning, and joy.

Candle Lighting

סְלוּעָה רָלַמְ וִיְהִי לָאֵלֶּיךָ הַתָּא רֹבֵב

Baruch atah Adonai, Eloheinu melech ha-olam,
Blessed are You, Adonai our God, Sovereign of the universe,

וְנוֹצֵצוֹ וְיִתְּנוּצְמוֹב וְנִשְׁדָּקְךָ רָשָׁא

asher kid'shanu b'mitzvotav v'tzivanu
who sanctifies us through mitzvot and commands us

תְּבַשׁ לֵשׁ רֵנָּה קִילְדִּיָּהּ

I'hadlik ner shel Shabbat.
to kindle the light of Shabbat.

Shalom Aleichem

תְּרַשָּׁה יִכְאַלֵּם סְכִילַע מוֹלֵשׁ

Shalom aleichem, malachei hasharet.
Peace be upon you, ministering angels.

Sing the melody your family knows, if desired.

Tonight in the Jewish Calendar

Today is Hoshana Rabbah, the seventh day of Sukkot. Tomorrow is Sh'mini Atzeret. Simchat Torah—הַיּוֹם תִּתְקַמֵּשׁ, “Joy of Torah”—celebrates completing the Torah-reading cycle and immediately beginning again.

Deuteronomy ends with Moses seeing the Promised Land and dying before entering it. Genesis immediately returns us to creation:

בְּרֵשִׁית בָּרָא אֱלֹהִים

Bereshit bara Elohim
In the beginning, God created

עֲרָאָה תְּאֻם סִימָשָׁה תָא

et hashamayim v'et ha-aretz.
the heavens and the earth.

TABLE QUESTION: Why might Judaism place the end and beginning of Torah beside each other?

Kiddush — Vayechulu

וַיְשֵׁשָׁה מוֹי רָקֵב יְהִי בְרָע יְהִי

Vay'hi erev vay'hi voker, yom hashishi.
There was evening and morning: the sixth day.

סָאֲבַצ לָכוּ עֲרָאָהּ סִימָשָׁה וְלָכוּ

Vay'chulu hashamayim v'ha-aretz v'chol tz'va-am.
The heavens and earth and all their array were completed.

הָשַׁע רָשָׁא וְתִכְאַלֵּם יַעֲיֹבְשָׁה מוֹיִב סִיְהִי לָכוּ

Vay'chal Elohim bayom hash'vi-i m'lachto asher asah,
On the seventh day God completed the work that God had done,

הָשַׁע רָשָׁא וְתִכְאַלֵּם לָכֵן יַעֲיֹבְשָׁה מוֹיִב תְּבִשְׂיו

vayishbot bayom hash'vi-i mikol m'lachto asher asah.
and ceased on the seventh day from all the work that God had done.

וְתָא שְׁדָקִיּוּ יַעֲיֹבְשָׁה מוֹי תָא סִיְהִי לָכוּ רָבְכוּ

Vay'varech Elohim et yom hash'vi-i vay'kadesh oto,
God blessed the seventh day and made it holy,

תּוֹשַׁעַל סִיְהִי לָא אָרְבָּ רָשָׁא וְתִכְאַלֵּם לָכֵן תְּבִשׁ וּבִי

ki vo shavat mikol m'lachto asher bara Elohim la-asot.
because on it God ceased from all the work that God had created to do.

Blessing over Wine

סְלוּעָה רָלַמְ וִיְהִי לָאֵלֶּיךָ הַתָּא רֹבֵב

Baruch atah Adonai, Eloheinu melech ha-olam,
Blessed are You, Adonai our God, Sovereign of the universe,

וְנוֹצֵצוֹ בֹרֵי פְרִי הָגָפֵן

borei p'ri hagafen.
Creator of the fruit of the vine.

Sanctification of Shabbat

סְלוּעָה רָלַמְ וִיְהִי לָאֵלֶּיךָ הַתָּא רֹבֵב

Baruch atah Adonai, Eloheinu melech ha-olam,
Blessed are You, Adonai our God, Sovereign of the universe,

וְנוֹב הַצָּרוֹ וְיִתְּנוּצְמוֹב וְנִשְׁדָּקְךָ רָשָׁא

asher kid'shanu b'mitzvotav v'ratzah vanu,
who sanctifies us through mitzvot and delights in us,

וְנוֹלִיחֵנָה וְנוֹצְרָבוּ הַבְּהָאֵב וְשְׁדָקְךָ תְּבִשְׂיו

v'Shabbat kodsho b'ahavah uv'ratzon hinchilanu,
and lovingly and willingly gives us holy Shabbat as our inheritance,

זִיכָרוֹן תִּישְׂאָרְבֵּי הַשְּׁעֵמֶל וְנוֹכְזוֹ

zikaron l'ma-aseh v'reishit.
a remembrance of the work of creation.

שְׁדָקְךָ יִמְכָּרְמֶל הַלְחָת מוֹי אוֹהֵיכִי

Ki hu yom t'chilah l'mikra-ei kodesh,
For it is the first of the sacred occasions,

זִכְרוֹן תִּישְׂאָרְבֵּי הַשְּׁעֵמֶל וְנוֹכְזוֹ

zecher litzi-at Mitzrayim.
a remembrance of the Exodus from Egypt.

מִימָעָה לָכֵן תִּשְׁדָּקְךָ וְנוֹתָנוּ תִּכְרָב וְנוֹבִיכִי

Ki vanu vacharta v'otanu kidashta mikol ha-amim,
For You chose us and sanctified us among all peoples,

וְנוֹתָנוּ וְנוֹצְרָבוּ הַבְּהָאֵב רָשָׁדָקְךָ תְּבִשְׂיו

v'Shabbat kodsh'cha b'ahavah uv'ratzon hinchaltanu.
and lovingly and willingly gave us Your holy Shabbat as an inheritance.

תְּבִשָּׁה שְׁדָקְכֵּי הַתָּא רֹבֵב

Baruch atah Adonai, m'kadesh haShabbat.
Blessed are You, Adonai, who sanctifies Shabbat.

Shabbat Table Reading — Back

Blessing • Bread • Torah • Gratitude • Peace

Blessing the Children

For a daughter

הָאֵלֹהִים יִלְחָר הַקָּדוֹר הַרְשֵׁכַּ מִיְהוָה רַמְיָשִׁי

Yesimech Elohim k'Sarah, Rivkah, Rachel v'Leah.

May God make you like Sarah, Rebecca, Rachel, and Leah.

For a son

הֶשְׁנַמְכּוּ מִרְפָּאֵךְ מִיְהוָה רַמְיָשִׁי

Yesimcha Elohim k'Ephraim v'chi-Menasheh.

May God make you like Ephraim and Manasseh.

Priestly Blessing

יְרַמְּשֵׁינוּ יְיָ רַכֵּבֵנוּ

Yevarechecha Adonai v'yishmerecha.

May Adonai bless you and protect you.

יְרַחֵם יְיָ אֵלֵינוּ וְיִפְּגֹשׁ יְיָ

Ya'er Adonai panav eilecha vichuneka.

May Adonai's presence shine upon you and be gracious to you.

יִסַּח יְיָ אֵלֵינוּ וְיִפְּגֹשׁ יְיָ

Yisa Adonai panav eilecha v'yasem l'cha shalom.

May Adonai turn toward you and grant you peace.

Hamotzi

בָּרוּךְ אַתָּה יְיָ אֱלֹהֵינוּ מֶלֶךְ הָעוֹלָם

Baruch atah Adonai, Eloheinu melech ha-olam,

Blessed are You, Adonai our God, Sovereign of the universe,

וְיָבִיא לָנוּ לֶחֶם מִן הָאָרֶץ

hamotzi lechem min ha-aretz.

who brings forth bread from the earth.

This week's Hebrew: lechem = bread • min = from • ha-aretz = the earth.

Simchat Torah — Why Begin Again?

On Simchat Torah we celebrate Torah through reading, singing, dancing with the scrolls, and beginning the annual cycle again.

The joy is not that we have mastered Torah; it is that we remain in relationship with it.

The final chapter of Deuteronomy leaves Moses on Mount Nebo. His work remains unfinished; Joshua and the next generation must continue. Then we return immediately to Bereshit—creation itself.

Torah may be the same, but we are not. We return carrying another year's experiences, losses, joys, questions, and wisdom.

TABLE QUESTION: If you could ask Torah one question this year, what would you ask?

Gratitude Around the Table

Each person names one ordinary thing from this week that they usually take for granted but are grateful for tonight.

After the Meal — Beginning Birkat HaMazon

A full Birkat HaMazon is traditionally recited after a meal containing bread. For now, begin with a short expression of thanksgiving:

בּוֹטֵיכָּ יְיָ וְדוּוּ

Hodu l'Adonai ki tov,

Give thanks to Adonai, for God is good;

יְיָ עוֹלָם וָעוֹלָם

ki l'olam chasdo.

God's lovingkindness endures forever.

Closing — From Ending to Beginning

Reader: This weekend Torah ends with Moses and begins again with creation. We learn, question, change, and return. May we enter another year of Torah with curiosity, humility, joy, and a willingness to see something we did not see before.

שַׁבָּת שְׁלוֹם וְחַג שָׂמֵחַ

Shabbat Shalom v'Chag Sameach.

A peaceful Shabbat and a joyful festival.

Sunday Beit Midrash Preview

Deuteronomy 34 → Genesis 1:1 → Rashi's first comment on Genesis. We will ask why Torah ends with Moses outside the land, why Genesis begins with creation, and why Rashi opens by asking whether Torah should have begun somewhere else.

TABLE QUESTION: What does Rashi think Torah is actually trying to teach us?